My Chemical Romance Top the Charts, 20 Years On

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Twenty years after its release, My Chemical Romance's "The Black Parade" has reached the top of the Billboard 200 chart. The 20th anniversary deluxe **reissue** took the top slot, giving the rock band its first Number One album in nearly 25 years together.

The **reissue** sold 78,000 **equivalent album units** across more than 20 formats and **variants** combined, Billboard reports. Released in 2006, "The Black Parade" was the band's third album, a full **rock opera** in the style of Queen that produced the Top Ten hit "Welcome to the Black Parade." It debuted at Number Two on the albums chart in 2006 and has since become a **landmark** rock record of the 21st century.

The band celebrated the album's 20th anniversary with a full **reissue** on October 23, and physical sales pushed it to the top. On Friday, the band also scored its first Number One on the United Kingdom's official album chart.

Notably, the 20-year-old album beat out Olivia Rodrigo's "You Seem Pretty Sad for a Girl So In Love." After midweek predictions showed My Chemical Romance winning by a thousand sales, Rodrigo cheered the band on, posting a clip from their show at New York's Citi Field, which she attended earlier this year. At that show, she met the band and took photos with them backstage.

The chart win comes in the middle of the band's Long Live the Black Parade tour, which kicked off in 2025. Last year they performed at their hometown stadium in New Jersey and took the show to London's Wembley Stadium for two sold-out nights, making the tour a career-defining run.

Word Treasure

reissue -- Releasing an album again, years after the first release.
equivalent album units -- A chart count that adds album sales and song streams together.
rock opera -- An album that tells one story through its songs, like an opera.
variants -- Different versions of the same album.
landmark -- An important record that many people remember.

Background you need

The Billboard 200 is a chart that ranks the most popular albums in the United States.

A rock opera is an album that tells one story across its songs, like a musical play.

Bands sometimes re-release an old album for an anniversary, with new packaging or extra versions.

Streaming and sales are both counted when charts rank albums today.

Break it down

LEAD: My Chemical Romance top the charts, 20 years on
KEY EVENT: The anniversary reissue reaches Number One
  +- SALES: 78,000 equivalent album units across more than 20 formats
  +- HISTORY: A 2006 third album, a rock opera, debuted at Number Two
  +- UK: A first Number One on Friday
RIVAL: Beat Olivia Rodrigo, who cheered the band on
TOUR: Long Live the Black Parade, with sold-out Wembley nights

Why it matters

Old songs can find new fans decades later, and a comeback like this shows how music can last far beyond its first release.

Test what you remember

1. What album topped the Billboard 200?

- (A) You Seem Pretty Sad for a Girl So In Love
- (B) Long Live the Black Parade
- (C) Welcome to the Black Parade
- (D) The Black Parade

2. How much did the reissue sell?

- (A) 78,000 equivalent album units
- (B) 20 formats
- (C) 1,000 sales
- (D) 25 years

3. When was the original album released?

- (A) October 23
- (B) Friday
- (C) 2025
- (D) 2006

4. Which song was a Top Ten hit?

- (A) You Seem Pretty Sad for a Girl So In Love
- (B) Welcome to the Black Parade
- (C) The Black Parade
- (D) Long Live the Black Parade

5. Who cheered the band on after the midweek predictions?

- (A) Wembley Stadium
- (B) Billboard
- (C) Olivia Rodrigo
- (D) Queen

6. Where did the band play sold-out nights last year?

- (A) Citi Field
- (B) The United Kingdom
- (C) Wembley Stadium
- (D) Their hometown stadium in New Jersey

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: A 3: D 4: B 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):